

ture of a web app, which is the HTML/CSS/JS (Hyper Text Markup Language/Cascading Style Sheets/JavaScript, for the uninitiated) holy trinity. What's interesting here is that this is the general structure for a regular extension of any other form that runs Gecko, showing that it's actually the very same engine that drives your desktop browser which is running under the hood of phones that are to be powered by B2G.

The core architecture of the Boot2Gecko project includes a Linux kernel at the system's core, which loads on boot, and continues to load into the Gecko-based run-time engine that thereforth manages the operation of the device. Mozilla's embrace of the HTML5 web standard is on clear display, as all the code and APIs are compliant of the specified web standards. Now, the three components that make up the complete operating system are:

1. Gaia
2. Gecko
3. Gonk

Let's go through a very brief overview of what each of those terms mean, and how they fit into the big picture.

- ▶ Gaia is the upper-level of the operating system, and is used to interface with the user and applications.
- ▶ Gecko, as we've discussed, is the rendering engine that runs at the core of the whole experience.
- ▶ Gonk is the lowest tier of the architecture, running the system level calls, and overseeing the Linux base of the operation.

Many may be wondering whether a new mobile operating system was really the need of the hour, considering the impact that has been made by the two existing behemoths, Android and iOS. But the fact of the matter is, the current mobile ecosystem doesn't fall in line with Mozilla's goal of making the web open and interoperable. The two operating systems run with



Firefox OS

We shall pursue openness to the ends of the Earth!